

Irishman's Prayer Answered At Last As Andy Cohen, Texas Hebrew, Wins Giant Berth



By LEON M. SILER

New York, June 24.—You find the name "Cohen" in the lineup of the New York Giants from time to time these days, and it isn't a typographical error.

It's the rugged, pungent, pulsating answer to a fervent Irish prayer.

The wearer of it is Andrew Howard Cohen. He has a face just like the great open spaces from which he came.

Among his other possessions are five feet eight and a half inches of height, 155 pounds of weight and some three months of professional baseball experience.

That's meager equipment for a New York Giant, in a way. But he's of the solid and substantial Hebrew cognomen graced the Giant bench only for a matter of hours before he busted into the real show.

That's how glad the Irish John J. McGraw was that his prayer at last had produced something resembling providential response.

There's a long story back of it. Almost as long as the years McGraw has guided the Giant's destinies. But it can be told in few words.

Search the Bronx, the East Side and sundry other portions of Gotham and you will discover a million or more actual or potential baseball fans in whose veins flows the blood of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob.

The Irish acumen of John McGraw

sensed the presence of this million long, long ago.

In every minor league and on every sandlot he sought for them—a Jewish Giant star.

Bennie Kauff came to cause rejoicing in McGraw's heart for awhile. But because of certain idiosyncrasies, Bennie failed to last.

This Cohen, 22 years of age and neat both at bat and on the base lines, is his successor.

Twenty thousand dollars and another player was his price. A "clever business stroke," the New York sport critics called it. The "twenty grand" will come back in two or three weeks, they hazarded, if Cohen makes good.

The sandlots of El Paso, Tex., gave "Andy" his start. Then these sandlots, none is sandier. Geographical phenomena worked with inheritance to fit Andy well for the part in the McGraw scheme of things he was to play.

Away back yonder Andy's daddy and John McGraw played baseball together on the Baltimore Orioles.

"My dad played under another name than Cohen though, I think," smiles Andy. "Jewish baseball players weren't much in demand then."

Andy specialized in basket ball and football as well as baseball when he went to high school in El Paso. Twice he piloted his high school basket ball fives to state championships.

Then he went to Alabama University for three years. A crack man on the diamond there, he signed up last season with Waco, of the Texas League, joining that team in June.

McGraw bought him on the strength of .312 batting and .916 fielding averages in 106 games, and recently sent him a hurry call to report to New York.

It's history now how Cohen, sent to bat for Frankie Frisch in the ninth inning of his first game with the Giants, delivered a single with a man on third base, and how a few minutes later the first colorful "Cohen to Kelly" putout was registered with Andy functioning at second.

They spin out Andy's life history with éclat and embroidery around New York now: how his Ma gave him a licking the first time he ever evinced a desire to play baseball, how his kid brother, Sidney, is setting a fast pace for Fort Bayard, New Mexico, in the Copper League, and how Andy doesn't smoke, drink, chew or swear and goes to bed regularly at 10:30 p. m.

"The big show? I—like it fine," contributes the subject matter of all this agitation—

This Andrew Howard Cohen, of the long-awaited "Cohen to Kelly" combine, the answer to an Irishman's prayer.

ers, therefore, have been eliminated, in the first nine holes but his re-